TCU Computer Science

Project Pulse
Glossary

Version <1.0>

Revision History

Date	Version	Description	Author
<dd/mmm/yy>	<x.x>	<details>	<name>

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Glossary

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This document is used to define terms used throughout the planning, design, and software development of this project. To be used by current and future software engineers as well as stakeholders to reference key terms that may cause confusion or any terms that need clarification. The glossary allows all parties involved in the project to have a standard definition of vocabulary, terms, or phrases. Also, this glossary will help define complex concepts and various abbreviations used throughout the project.

1.2 Scope

This glossary is associated with the Peer Evaluation Tool project. The terms in this document will be used in the Vision and Scope document, the Use Case document, and other project documents.

1.3 References

1.4 Overview

The remnant of this document contains terms followed by their definitions. Terms that can be grouped together will have the same index number followed by a separate identifying digit.

2. Definitions

2.1 Senior Design Section

Texas Christian University Department of Computer Science offers a two-course sequence (COSC 40943: Software Engineering and COSC 40993: Senior Design) where senior students, working in teams, provide solutions to realistic and meaningful problems. Each project is staffed by a team of 5 to 6 students working with a real external client on a software project from end to end. By working closely with the client, students define the problem statement, analyze the problem domain, design, implement, test, deploy, and document a solution. Students will employ agile development methodologies and adopt good software engineering practices like code reviews, refactoring, source control, continuous integration and delivery, automated testing, etc.

In this project, the term "Senior Design Section" denotes a particular offering of the two-course sequence designed for students in their senior year. This section commences at the end of August and typically concludes by the end of April of the following year. As of now, all senior students are enrolled in the same section.

Section name format: YYYY-YYYY. E.g., 2023-2024, 2024-2025.

2.2 Senior Design Team

A senior design team is a group of senior-level students collaborating on a capstone project that integrates their academic knowledge and skills. This project, a requirement for graduation, challenges the team to design, develop, and implement a solution to a real-world problem, often provided by industry partners or faculty members. The team works together through the entire project lifecycle - from initial concept and design, through development and testing, to final presentation and delivery. This experience prepares students for professional practice by emphasizing teamwork, project management, technical expertise, and communication skills. A team usually consists of 5 - 6 students.

2.3 TCU Online

A course management system used by TCU. Students can upload homework to it and view their grades. It does not support peer evaluations.

2.4 Academic Year

An academic year is the period of time used by educational institutions to measure the quantity of study. It typically spans from the early fall of one year to the early summer of the next year, divided into two or more segments, often called semesters, depending on the institution. The academic year usually covers a span of about nine to ten months and is often used as a framework for curriculum planning, course scheduling, and the administration of schools and universities. It provides a structured timeline for students and faculty to follow for instruction, examinations, holidays, and graduation.

2.5 Active Week

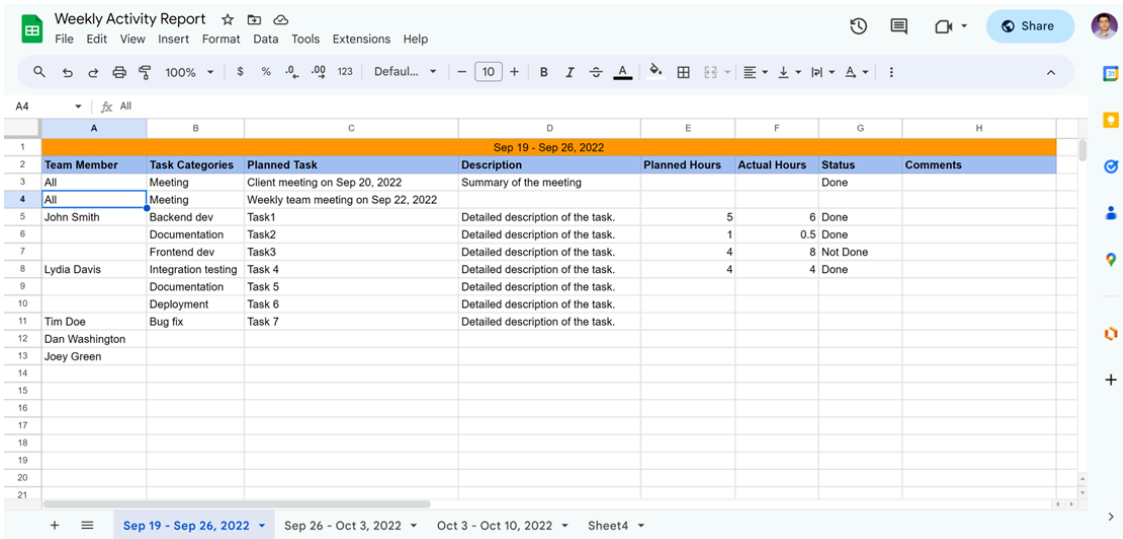
A senior design student is required to submit weekly activity reports and peer evaluations after her project starts. An active week denotes a week that a senior design student must submit those reports. Since a senior design section includes a winter holiday break, the admin shall be able to specify which weeks are "inactive" so that students no longer need to submit reports during those weeks.

A week starts on Monday and ends on Sunday. We may use Monday's date as the Id for a week.

2.6 Weekly Activity Report (WAR)

A weekly activity report or WAR provides a structured overview of the progress, challenges, and next steps for a project team. It serves as a tool for communication among team members, as well as with instructors and stakeholders. A WAR consists of multiple activities. Each student specifies what they did during the

week: activity category, planned activity, a description of the activity, hours planned, actual hours taken, and the status of the activity. Here is an example:



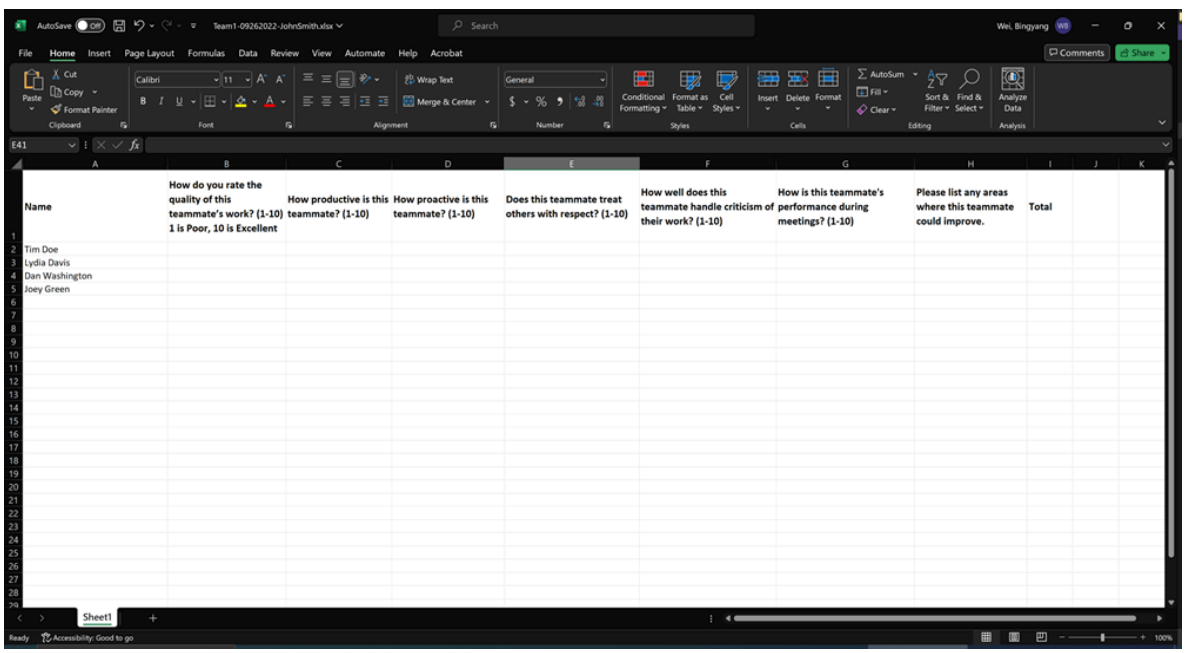
Sep 19 - Sep 26, 2022

Team Member	Task Categories	Planned Task	Description	Planned Hours	Actual Hours	Status	Comments
All	Meeting	Client meeting on Sep 20, 2022	Summary of the meeting			Done	
All	Meeting	Weekly team meeting on Sep 22, 2022					
John Smith	Backend dev	Task1	Detailed description of the task.	5	6	Done	
	Documentation	Task2	Detailed description of the task.	1	0.5	Done	
	Frontend dev	Task3	Detailed description of the task.	4	8	Not Done	
Lydia Davis	Integration testing	Task 4	Detailed description of the task.	4	4	Done	
	Documentation	Task 5	Detailed description of the task.				
	Deployment	Task 6	Detailed description of the task.				
Tim Doe	Bug fix	Task 7	Detailed description of the task.				
Dan Washington							
Joey Green							

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1jpxBQ8Gvv94bRl1gSpBzXRFxJu7IQXKjQZ5n28-EpD8/edit?usp=sharing

2.7 Peer Evaluation

A peer evaluation for a senior design team allows team members to assess each other's contributions, performance, and teamwork skills every week. The peer evaluation helps identify strengths and areas for improvement and ensures accountability within the team. Here is an example of a peer evaluation for a week:



Name	How do you rate the quality of this teammate's work? (1-10) 1 is Poor, 10 is Excellent	How productive is this teammate? (1-10)	How proactive is this teammate? (1-10)	Does this teammate treat others with respect? (1-10)	How well does this teammate handle criticism of their work? (1-10)	How is this teammate's performance during meetings? (1-10)	Please list any areas where this teammate could improve.	Total
Tim Doe								
Lydia Davis								
Dan Washington								
Joey Green								

2.7.1 Public Comments

When evaluating a team member, a student can optionally provide public comments to this team member. Public comments will be sent to the evaluatee.

2.7.2 Private Comments

When evaluating a team member, a student can optionally provide private comments to the instructor. Private comments will NOT be sent to the evaluatee.

2.8 Rubric

The peer evaluation is based on a rubric. A rubric is a scoring guide used to evaluate the performance, work quality, behavior, or contributions of peers against a set of predefined criteria. It outlines specific expectations for an assignment or performance task and provides a detailed scale for assessing each criterion, usually ranging from poor to excellent performance levels.

Here is the rubric in use:

- How do you rate the quality of this teammate's work? (1-10) 1 is Poor, 10 is Excellent
- How productive is this teammate? (1-10)
- How proactive is this teammate? (1-10)
- Does this teammate treat others with respect? (1-10)
- How well does this teammate handle criticism of their work? (1-10)
- How is this teammate's performance during meetings? (1-10)

2.8.1 Criterion

In a rubric, a criterion refers to a specific standard or aspect of performance, work, or behavior that is being evaluated. Criteria are the individual components that together define the expectations for the performance in a week. Each criterion is designed to assess a particular element of the work, such as clarity of argument, depth of analysis, creativity, teamwork, participation, technical skill, or any other relevant characteristic. Examples of criteria can be found in the Rubric section.